29. Siegel, Endgame .

30. While the British shied away from the term ‘sphere of influence’, this was undoubtedly what the convention created. For further information regarding the negotiations and details of the convention, see Gooch and Temperley, eds, British Documents on the Origins of the War 1898–1914. Vol. IV, The Anglo-Russian Rapprochement 1903–1907 .

31. Kazemzadeh, Russia and Britain in Persia. A Study in Imperialism, 1864–1914 , pp. 507–8 (hereafter Russia and Britain).

32. The American minister in Tehran claimed that it was commonly believed ‘that the “Bear” had gotten the “Lion’s” share’: Greaves, ‘Some Aspects of the Anglo-Russian Convention and Its Working in Persia, 1907–1914 – I’, Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies, University of London, Vol. 13 (1968), p. 80.

33. Churchill, op. cit., p. 325.

34. McLean, ‘English Radicals, Russia and the Fate of Persia 1907–1913’, The English Historical Review , Vol. 93, No. 367 (1978), p. 346 (hereafter ‘English Radicals’). For full information regarding the reception of the Convention in Parliament, see Hansard Parliamentary Debates , 4th Series, Vol. 183, 29 Jan. – 11 Feb. 1908. Also, Hansard Parliamentary Debates , 4th Series, Vol. 184, 12 Feb. – 26 Feb. 1908.

35. McLean, Buffer State, p. 104.

36. McLean, ‘English Radicals’, p. 345.

37. Ross, ‘Lord Curzon and E.G. Browne Confront the ‘Persian Question’’, The Historical Journal , Vol. 52 (2009), pp. 402–5.

38. McLean, ‘English Radicals’, p. 340.

39. Ibid ., p. 346.

40. Neilson, Last Tsar , p. 325.